Assignment 02

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Instructions

As we have already discussed that critical listening is the form of active listening that focuses on challenging and evaluating the content in question, your second assignment is to critically evaluate the “Threads vs. Twitter” issue under the light of several perspectives.

In order to complete the assignment, follow the steps one by one and answer the questions asked. Each section of the assignment depends on particular videos that you will need to watch in order to accurately answer the given questions.

STEP ONE: Watch Video 1 and attempt the questions provided in the section 1.

SECTION 1 (3+2+2= 7 marks)

- For this section, online resources or a generative AI tool can be used. You must provide references for online resources and the prompt used in the case of generative AI tool.
- Make sure that you refer back to the provided video in order to accurately answer the provided questions

Question 1: What do you know about the history of Twitter? Provide references in your answer. (no more than 200 words)

Over the past decade, Twitter evolved from a promising social media platform that went public in 2013 to private power by Elon Musk, the world's richest person and a Twitter stoner. Twitter faced challenges, including profitability, competition with tech titans like Google and Facebook, and difficulties over fake news and political bias.

Created in 2006 by Jack Dorsey, Noah Glass, Biz Stone, and Evan Williams, Twitter gained popularity in 2007 after a $100,000 backing round and creation at South by Southwest. In 2011, it played a crucial part in the Arab Spring protests.

In the following times, Twitter grappled with operation changes, slow stoner growth, and difficulties in its announcement business. Donald Trump's use of Twitter for communication underlined its artistic significance.

In 2021, Twitter permanently banned Trump and passed a leadership change, with Jack Dorsey stepping down as CEO.

In 2022, Elon Musk acquired Twitter and made significant changes, including labor force shakeups.

This condensed history reflects Twitter's global impact and its struggles to remain applicable and profitable in the ever- changing social media geography.

References:

1. Twitter is now owned by Elon Musk — here's a brief history from the app's founding in 2006 to the present-CNBC: https://www.cnbc.com/2022/10/29/a-brief-history-of-twitter-from-its-founding-in-2006-to-musk-takeover.html

2.Twitter - Wikipedia: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Twitter

Question 2: Is the information provided in the Video 1 accurate? Do you think some other points need to be added? Give at least two reasons for your answer (no more than 100 words)

I think the video could have been more informative if it provided more information regarding the Twitter Files event which took place from December 2022 till March 2023. This took place after Elon Musk acquired Twitter and released internal files that cover the decision to ban Trump, Twitter's decision to block a story in October 2020 from material on Hunter Biden's laptop, and it limits the reach of accounts that break its rules. I also think the video is incomplete because of how it focuses on Twitter being this massive knowledge hub while in reality, Twitter is a cesspool of degeneracy and has been for a long time.

Question 3: How do you think Twitter changed the paradigm of online communication? (no more than 100 words)

Twitter's microblogging format, with its 140-character limit (later 280), revolutionized online communication. It prioritized speed and trending topics, enabling rapid information sharing.. Twitter introduced hashtags and retweets, influencing modern social media conventions and serving as a vital tool for influencers, activists, and organizations. It transformed how we share and engage with information online.

STEP TWO: Watch the videos 2 and 3, then attempt the questions provided in section 2.

SECTION 2 (5*5=25 marks)

- You are not allowed to use any internet resources or generative AI to attempt the questions in this section.
- Your answers must totally refer to the actual content of the videos, otherwise marks will be deducted.

Question 1: What kind of perspective is being discussed in video 2? What is the gist of the discussion? (no more than 100 words)

In this discussion, the perspective seems very positive from the guest. She seems to think that Threads will provide Twitter a daunting challenge and that Twitter is in danger. The gist of the discussion is how the guest, Katie, believes that Threads will be a good opportunity for new creators or brands to establish their presence in a more natural way and how Threads had millions and millions of downloads on its first day. She also addresses some concerns regarding how your Instagram account and Threads account are linked and if one is deleted the other will follow suit.

Question 2: Do you agree with the guest's opinion in video 2? Why or why not? Does she seem biased? (no more than 100 words)

I do not agree with the guest's opinion. My reasoning is that she is the creator of a social media agency which exists, as all businesses do, to make money. She profits greatly from the promotion of as many social media platforms as possible and I believe that she is too heavily biased for me to consider her as a proper source of information that I can use to make judgements. I also believe that Threads is an all out rip-off of Twitter and that Elon Musk is justified in his criticisms of the platform being not competition but a copy.

Question 3: What is the gist of the message being provided in video 3? Justify your answer with logical reasoning. (no more than 100 words)

To me, the video is simply an excuse to criticize Twitter and to promote how "good" Threads is. The gist of the video is that Twitter is now an outdated platform which has been improved upon and it's concept is now being implemented better by Mark Zuckerberg in the shape of Threads. The video talks in detail about everything that Threads does better than Twitter. For example, comparison is made between the time taken by both platforms to reach a million users however

the fact that Threads is launched by a very experienced and well established company and Twitter was created by a couple of normal people.

Question 4: Write at least THREE differences and TWO similarities between Twitter & Threads as discussed in video 3. Provide time stamps. An example is given below. Do you think that launching 'Threads' was a wise move? Why or why not? (no more than 150 words)

Just like twitter, 'Threads' is a microblogging app [00:05:56]

You can "Doomscroll" on both platforms. [0:20]

Twitter post length is 280 characters and Threads' is 500 characters [1:28]

Threads doesn't use hashtags and Twitter thrives off them [1:40]

Threads lacks search feature for specific text meanwhile Twitter offers this feature [1:47]

Launching Threads was not a wise move as it was a pure Twitter rip-off and only worked till people were talking about Elon Musk and his erratic decisions. Now that Elon isn't making absurd changes, people have adapted to Twitter once more.

Question 5: By analyzing the tone, body language and facial expressions of each speaker (guest speaker in video 02 & the speaker in video 03), discuss how the mentioned non-verbal cues affect the speakers' message? (no more than 170 words)

In video 2, the guest speaker maintains a hopeful tone throughout the discussion. Her facial expressions seem happy and excited and her body language is being used to emphasize points that she wants to and to differentiate between points that she wishes to. Her non-verbal cues give an effect to the video where the viewer may also adopt her positive outlook on the matter at hand but in my opinion for someone a little more informed it may come off as naive.

In video 3, the speaker maintains a professional stance throughout the video. Her facial expressions are similar throughout the discussion with slight smiles here and there which give a very professional vibe to the viewer. Her body language is very still other than her hands which she uses to emphasize points as needed. In my opinion, these verbal cues make it seem as

though her message is very important and must be heard as it is coming from someone knowledgeable.

STEP THREE: You are required to do some research in order to answer the question provided in section 3. You must also link the information given in videos 04 & 05 with your answers

SECTION 3 (4+4= 8 marks)

- You are allowed to use online resources and/or generative AI
- Provide citation & references
- DO NOT copy paste otherwise you will be given zero marks

Question: Why do you think '*Threads*' hasn't been able to uphold its original hype? What do you think is the biggest reason for its fall from grace? (no more than 250-270 words)

I think that Threads has been unable to uphold its original hype because of a few reasons that I'd like to go over.

Firstly, the app was made to attract users who were dissatisfied with X (formerly known as Twitter) however Meta refuses to make it like X content-wise. They seem to refrain from hard news as it is definitely not good for a new platform which requires advertisers as seen from X's loss of advertisers which Elon Musk informed the public about after his acquisition of X on his own account.

Another reason would be that it was marketed as a Twitter clone and a challenge to Twitter simultaneously while failing miserably at both. The app had an initial boom only due to large content creators, influencers and famous personalities making their accounts. Another reason for the initial boom was that after Elon Musk's acquisition of Twitter, he has made some very questionable decisions regarding view limits and paid subscriptions for verification check marks which left a bad taste in the public's mouths.

Expanding further, we can look at a quote from Kevin Driscoll, associate professor of Media Studies at University of Virginia; "When I open it, I see a lot of very generic content that seems to be coming from a

team of brand managers or public figures, As opposed to what made Twitter feel exciting and compelling in its heyday, which was more direct conversation and live responses to things that were unfolding." (Ref. Meta's Threads Is Already Unraveling | TIME)

I'd like to conclude by stating that in my opinion Threads was doomed from its inception as it provided no new value in the market and simply became known as a Twitter-copy instead of having its own identity.